

Categorizing Sin

Cyclical Sins-

- **Nature:** The recurring patterns of sin that every person and every generation falls into.
- **Scope:** Universal and perpetual — the “wheel” of human failure.
- **Outcome:** Repeated stumbling; opens and closes doors in personal and communal life, but does not alter history itself.
- **Examples:** envy, lies, lust, anger, greed, pride.

Two sub-categories of cyclical sin:

- **Divine Sins-**
 - **Nature:** Sins that begin in weakness, blindness, or rebellion, but are transformed by God into instruments of growth and restoration.
 - **Scope:** Personal or communal, impactful to a greater cause.
 - **Outcome:** Growth, refinement, and sanctification — God transforms the apparent darkness into light.
 - **Examples:** Peter’s denial (which led to humility and restoration), Job’s cries of despair (which led to deeper revelation of God).
- **Shadow Sins-**
 - **Nature:** Acts rooted in selfishness, rebellion, or pride.
 - **Scope:** Personal, communal.
 - **Outcome:** Always destruction — leads to death, whether physical, relational, or spiritual.
 - **Examples:** Saul’s disobedience, Ananias and Sapphira’s deceit, idolatry that ends in exile.

Critical Sins-

- **Nature:** Rare, history-altering acts of disobedience or betrayal.
- **Scope:** Global, covenantal, cosmic.
- **Outcome:** They change the course of salvation history itself.
- **Examples:** The Fall (Adam & Eve), Cain’s murder of Abel, Judas’ betrayal, David’s census.